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JainSarthi

High-Level Feature Document

A Spiritual Companion Application for the Jain Community

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1. Introduction

JainSarathi is a mobile and web application designed to serve as a spiritual companion for the Jain community. The purpose of this document is to describe, at a high level and in plain, non-technical language, the core features planned for the application. This document is intended to give the reader a clear understanding of what the application will do for its users, without going into technical or engineering detail.

The application brings together daily religious practice, community events, sacred knowledge, and real-time community information into a single, easy-to-use platform — replacing the current reliance on scattered WhatsApp groups, printed notices, and word-of-mouth updates.

2. Events

The Events feature allows users to discover, track, and get reminded about religious and community events happening around them.

What the user can do

- See a list of events happening nearby, along with the exact location and timing of each event.
- Receive an alert or reminder shortly before an event begins, so they do not miss it.
- Tap a location button inside any event's details to view that event's venue directly on a map.
- Choose how far they want to see events from — for example, within 20 km, 50 km, or another distance of their choosing.
- Automatically receive notifications for events posted by their own Sangh or group, regardless of distance.

Types of events supported

- Recurring daily events, such as a daily Pravachan (religious discourse) or daily Pratikraman.
- Major festival and observance days, such as Mahavir Jayanti, Paryushan Parva, and other significant occasions in the Jain calendar.
- One-time community events posted by a local Sangh, such as celebrations, gatherings, or special programs.

In short: users always know what is happening, when, and where — and are reminded in time to attend, whether the event is a daily practice, a festival, or a one-off community gathering.

3. Community Map

A dedicated map built specifically for the Jain community, showing places and points of interest that matter to daily religious and community life — not a generic map, but one curated for this purpose.

What will be shown on the map

- Temples (Derasars) and their locations.

- Bhojanshalas (community dining halls) offering Jain meals.
- Vihar points — places along a monk or nun's travel route that are relevant to the community.
- Event locations, so any event in the Events feature can be viewed on the same map.
- Jain-friendly hotels or lodging that may be useful for travelers and pilgrims.

This turns the map into a single, trusted reference point for anything location-related in the app, rather than requiring users to search separately for each type of place.

4. Maharaj Saheb (Sadhu-Sadhvi) Location Tracking

This feature allows the community to know the current location of Sadhus and Sadhvis (Jain monks and nuns) as they travel on foot (Vihar) from place to place. This is a meaningful but sensitive feature to build correctly, since Sadhus and Sadhvis do not carry phones, so their location cannot be tracked automatically the way a person's location normally would be.

How the information will be collected

- Rather than automatic tracking, location information will be collected manually — a designated person from a nearby Sangh, or someone accompanying the Vihar, will note down the current location.
- This information will be compiled, for example in a simple spreadsheet, and then uploaded into the application by an authorized person.
- Once uploaded, the location becomes visible to users on the map, along with any relevant details (such as which Sangh or Upashray they are near, or their expected direction of travel).

What the feature enables for users

- Users can see where a Sadhu or Sadhvi is currently located, or if they are currently in transit (Vihar).
- When a Sadhu or Sadhvi is approaching a particular area, nearby Sanghs can be notified in advance — allowing interested community members to plan to join the Vihar or be present for their arrival.
- In many cases, a Sadhu or Sadhvi's stop coincides with an existing Sangh location or a known Vihar point already on the map — in these cases, that existing location can simply be reused and the relevant community members notified, without needing entirely new location data.

This feature depends on voluntary reporting by community members and Sangh coordinators, since continuous automatic tracking is not possible or appropriate. The application is designed to make the best use of whatever location updates are available, and to notify the right people whenever an update is received.

5. Daily Interaction & Engagement

This feature is designed to give users a reason to open the application every single day, by combining small, meaningful pieces of daily religious content and practical daily information in one place.

Daily content

- A new quote or short story shared daily, offering users an easy and enjoyable way to learn something small each day.
- An interesting fact or piece of information about a temple, deity, or other aspect of Jain heritage, shown for a few seconds when the app is opened — designed to make the app feel engaging from the very first moment.

Daily practical information

- Sunrise and sunset timings for the user's location.
- Navkarshi and Pachkhan timings (fasting/vow-related timings observed daily).
- Today's Tithi (the day in the Jain religious calendar).
- A daily notification informing the user what should be avoided on that particular Tithi, based on religious guidelines.

Calendar access

- A dedicated calendar showing Tithis and events, which users can refer to at any time, not just through daily notifications.

Optional voice guidance

- An optional voice message guiding users through the process of taking a Pachkhan (a religious vow), for users who would find audio guidance helpful.

6. News

The News feature keeps the community informed about both large-scale and local happenings, with clear separation between the two so users are never confused about what is relevant to them.

How news is organized

- Global news: major events and announcements relevant to the wider Jain community, uploaded by a global-level Sangh administrator, including photos.
- Local news: local Sanghs can also share their own local events as news, visible only to members associated with that particular Sangh — keeping local updates relevant and uncluttered for everyone else.
- These two types of news are organized into two separate, clearly labeled tabs, so users can easily tell global updates apart from news specific to their own Sangh.

Finding news

- A search and filter option is provided, so users can quickly find news on a specific topic, event, or time period rather than scrolling through everything.

7. Knowledge Base

A dedicated space within the app for learning and reference material related to Jain practice and philosophy. This includes information on Pachkhan (religious vows), reference books, and other educational material that community members may want to explore or refer back to at their own pace.

8. Language Support

To make the application accessible to as much of the community as possible, the application will support multiple languages.

- In the first phase, the application will support Hindi and English.
- Once the application is established, support for additional languages will be considered, based on the needs of the community.

9. Religious Activity Calendar & Tracking

Building on the daily calendar described earlier, this feature allows users to log their own daily religious activity and see it reflected against the calendar, giving them a simple, personal way to track their practice over time.

What this enables today

- A simple daily form where users can record their religious activity for the day.
- This activity is mapped onto the corresponding date in the calendar, so users can look back and see a clear record of what they have done, and notice any gaps in their routine.

Planned for the future

- An automated reminder system: for example, if a user has not visited the temple on a given day, they would receive a gentle reminder notification the next day, around the temple's usual timing.
- The intent behind this future feature is purely motivational — a light, encouraging nudge to help users stay consistent with their personal religious practice, not a tracking or scoring system.

10. Summary of Feature Scope

The table below summarizes all features described in this document for quick reference.

Feature	What It Does For The User
Events	Discover nearby and Sangh-specific events (daily, recurring, and festival), with location, timing, and reminders.
Community Map	One dedicated map showing temples, bhojanshalas, vihar points, event locations, and Jain-friendly hotels.
Maharaj Saheb Location Tracking	Community-reported location updates for traveling Sadhus/Sadhvis, with nearby-Sangh notifications.
Daily Interaction & Engagement	Daily quotes, facts, sunrise/sunset and Pachkhan timings, Tithi guidance, and an always-available calendar.
News	Global and local news in separate tabs, with photos and a search/filter option.
Knowledge Base	Reference material on Pachkhan, books, and other Jain educational content.
Language Support	Hindi and English at launch, with more languages planned later.
Religious Activity Calendar & Tracking	Personal daily activity logging mapped to the calendar, with future motivational reminders.

This document reflects the current high-level feature scope as of the date shown on the cover page. It is intended for discussion and evaluation purposes and may evolve as the application is further planned and developed.